

DAY 3 POULTRY INTERMEDIATE LEVEL

AGRI_EMPOWER POULTRY BOOTCAMP: DAY 3

MODULE 2: BIOSECURITY & ENVIRONMENT CONTROL

GOAL: PREVENT LOSSES BEFORE THEY HAPPEN

A professional farmer does not wait for birds to get sick. You must create a "Fortress" that diseases cannot enter.

1. THE THREE PILLARS OF BIOSECURITY

- **Isolation:** Keep your birds away from other animals (pigs, wild birds, neighborhood chickens) and unauthorized people.
- **Traffic Control:** Manage the movement of people, equipment, and vehicles onto and within the farm.
- **Sanitation:** The physical cleaning and disinfection of boots, hands, clothes, and equipment.

2. FARM ZONING: CLEAN VS. DIRTY AREAS

You must divide your farm into distinct zones to prevent cross-contamination:

- **Green Zone (Clean):** The office, feed store, and staff changing rooms.
- **Yellow Zone (Transition):** The area where you wash boots and change into farm-only clothes.
- **Red Zone (Dirty/High Risk):** The actual poultry pens. Only authorized personnel in farm gear should enter here.

3. DISEASE ENTRY POINTS

Disease doesn't have wings; it is carried. The most common entry points are:

- **Human Boots & Clothes:** Carrying germs from the market or other farms.

- **Contaminated Equipment:** Sharing egg crates or feeders with neighbors.
- **Rodents & Wild Birds:** They carry Salmonella and Avian Influenza.
- **Water Sources:** Untreated borehole or well water.

4. ENVIRONMENTAL CONTROL

- **Ventilation Management:** Proper airflow removes heat, moisture, and poisonous gases. The air should always feel fresh at the birds' level. If you see birds panting or huddling in corners, your ventilation is failing.
 - **Ammonia Detection:** If you can smell ammonia (the sharp "pee" smell), it is already too high. High ammonia burns the birds' lungs and eyes, making them vulnerable to respiratory diseases.
 - **Heat Stress Control:** In high temperatures, birds stop eating. Use "Cross-Ventilation" (opening windows fully) and ensure the roof is high enough to allow heat to rise and escape.
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THE HUMAN ELEMENT: WORKER DISCIPLINE

Even the best biosecurity plan fails without **Worker Discipline**.

- **The "One-Way" Rule:** Always move from the youngest/healthiest birds to the oldest/sickest birds. Never go back.
- **No Visiting:** Staff must be prohibited from visiting other poultry farms or "backyard" birds at home.
- **The Checklist:** Every morning must start with a routine—Change → Disinfect → Inspect.

Daily Farm Routine Checklist:

1. Check water levels and sanitation.
 2. Monitor feed intake (did they finish yesterday's feed?).
 3. Remove any mortality immediately.
 4. Check litter for wet spots.
 5. Inspect ventilation (curtain adjustment).
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PRACTICAL WORKSHOP

Activity 1: Identify 5 Risks in a Typical Farm

1. Open gates that allow stray dogs or neighbors to walk in.
2. Using the same boots inside the pen that were worn to the market.

3. Allowing wild birds to enter through holes in the wire mesh.
4. Keeping "mortality" (dead birds) near the feed store.
5. Using dirty egg crates from a third party.

Activity 2: Create a Simple Biosecurity Plan

- **Step 1:** Install a locked gate with a "No Admittance" sign.
- **Step 2:** Place a footbath with fresh disinfectant at every pen entrance.
- **Step 3:** Designate "Farm-Only" boots and overalls.
- **Step 4:** Implement a strict rodent control program (bait stations).
- **Step 5:** Schedule a weekly "Deep Clean" of all surroundings.